In the workshop with... Larry Wise

We go into the workshop with Canadian woodturner Larry Wise

Larry has always done woodworking as a hobby, but it has been within the past few years that he got a little more serious about it. Larry was designing a new style of Adirondack chair, with the idea that he could help raise money for Wounded Warriors Canada. Borrowing a wood lathe from a family member and with no experience, he began to learn the fine art of woodturning. After reading and watching videos from very experienced turners, Larry listened to their suggestions about starting with something simple like rolling pins. He thought 'if I can make segmented bowls, then why not segmented rolling pins?' and Larry has been trying to continually take his creativity one step further ever since.

PHOTOGRAPHS BY LARRY WISE

How, when and why did you start turning?

I started about a year ago, without having any experience or even knowing anyone around who even did woodturning. I began to learn as much as I could from books and videos

What and who are the greatest influences on your work?

When I first started I bought the book *Woodturning with Ray Allen*. I was amazed at what he could do with wood. After reading his story on how he started and what he did, it was a big influence for me and that's when I thought, 'why can't I do that, but with rolling pins?'

If you were to offer one sage piece of advice to someone what would it be?

Practise and don't be afraid to try something different but, be safe doing it. If you have an idea then do it, don't give up until you're done. Let the finished product decide and go from there

WT_289_83_85_IN_THE_WORKSHOP_WITH_bdJRmbS.indd 83 22/12/2015 10:27